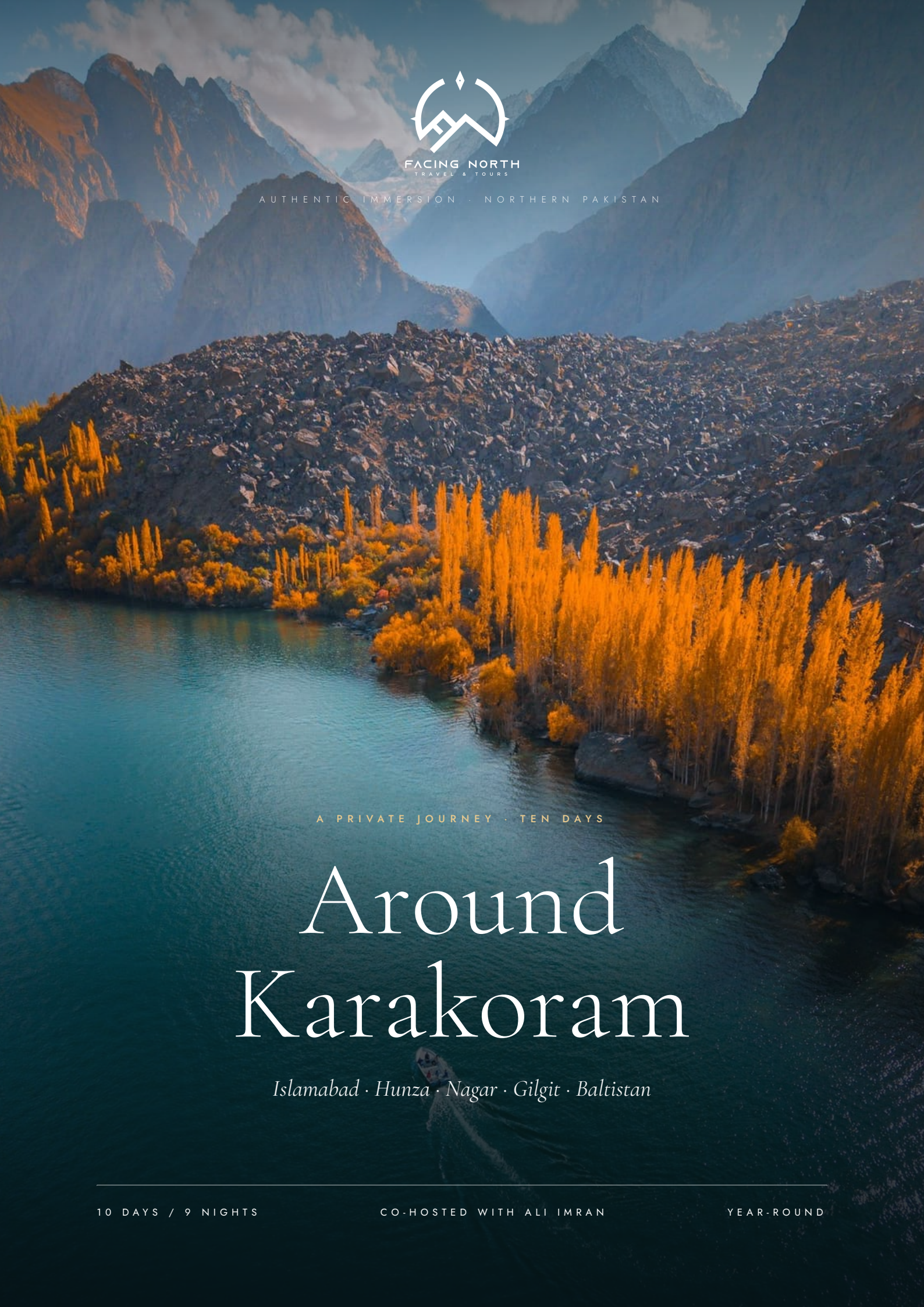


FACING NORTH
TRAVEL & TOURS

AUTHENTIC IMMERSION · NORTHERN PAKISTAN

A PRIVATE JOURNEY · TEN DAYS

Around Karakoram

Islamabad · Hunza · Nagar · Gilgit · Baltistan

10 DAYS / 9 NIGHTS

CO-HOSTED WITH ALI IMRAN

YEAR-ROUND



Rakaposhi above the Hunza orchards

THE HOOK

Why this trip exists

Ten days that take you from a capital built in the 1960s to a fort that was already old when it was built, by way of the Karakoram Highway — the paved descendant of the Silk Road — and a cricket ground cut into a mountainside with a 7,788-metre peak standing behind the boundary.

Three valleys, two 400-year-old kitchens, five peaks over seven thousand metres in a single frame — and a film crew with you the whole way, so you come home with the footage as well as the memory.

THE VIBE

PHYSICAL INTENSITY	Comfortable throughout. Two optional short hikes of 30–40 minutes; otherwise forts, lakes and viewpoints reached by vehicle or jeep. No trekking, no camping.
COMFORT LEVEL	Nishat Islamabad, Serena Hunza, Serena Gilgit and Himmel Resort Skardu — a proper hotel every night, all meals handled, and only four changes of base in ten days.
CULTURAL DEPTH	Burushaski, Shina and Balti valleys back to back. Four forts and palaces spanning a thousand years, two traditional meals cooked by local families, and a live folk night in Hunza.
ROAD TIME	One long transfer on Day 2, Skardu to Hunza, and a three-and-a-half-hour run back down to Skardu on Day 6. Domestic flights at both ends remove everything else.



AT A GLANCE

The Route

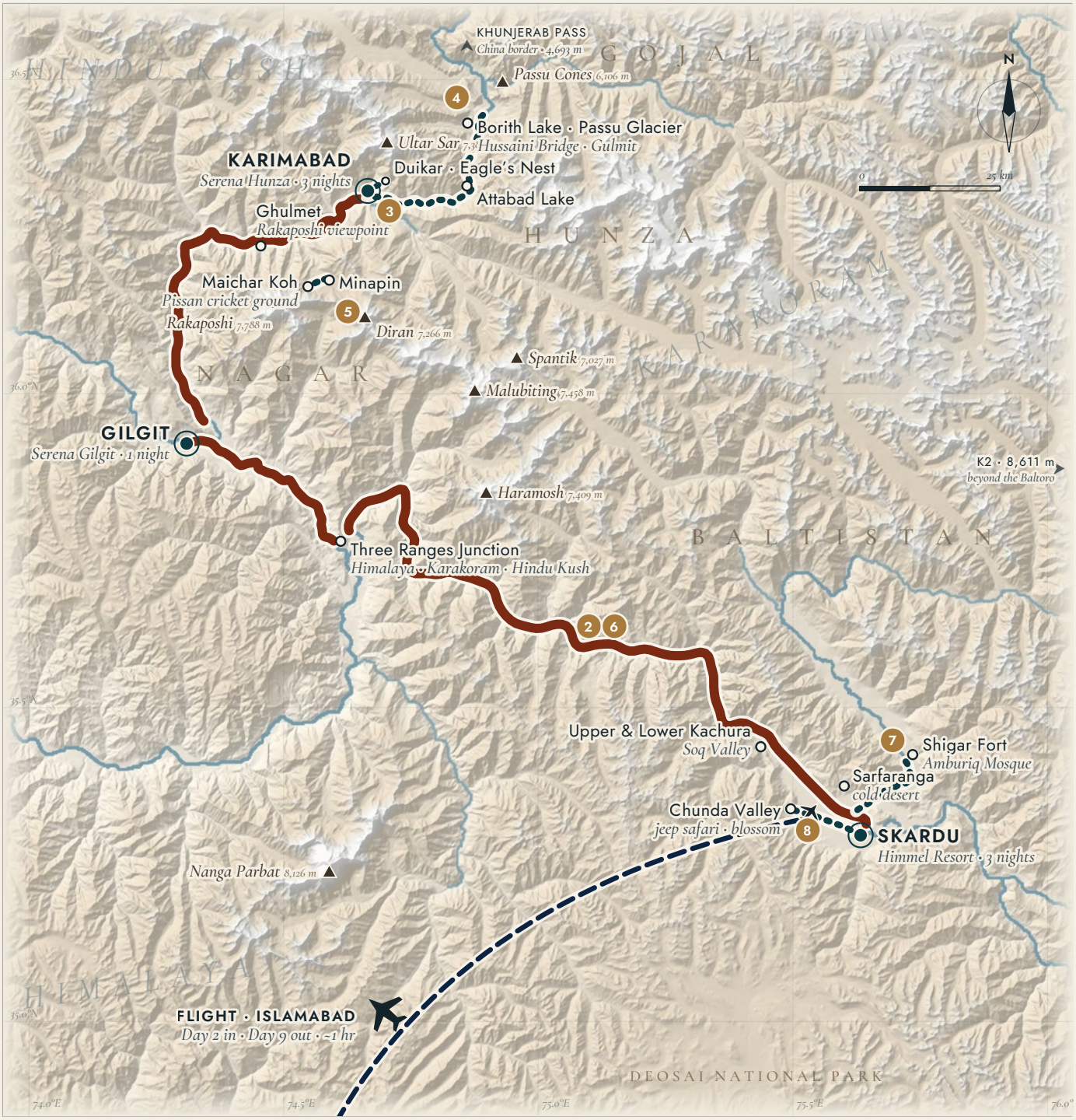
10	4	3	5	2	1
DAYS	HOTELS	VALLEYS	PEAKS OVER 7,000 M	DOMESTIC FLIGHTS	FILM CREW

DAY	WHERE	WHAT	OVERNIGHT
01	Islamabad	*Faisal Mosque, Pakistan Monument, Saidpur*	NISHAT HOTEL
02	Skardu → Hunza	*Fly north, then the JSR and the Silk Road*	SERENA HUNZA
03	Central Hunza	*Baltit, Altit, 400-year-old kitchen, Eagle's Nest*	SERENA HUNZA
04	Upper Hunza	*Attabad, Borith, Passu Glacier, Hussaini Bridge*	SERENA HUNZA
05	Nagar → Gilgit	*Maichar Koh cricket ground, stone-pot lunch*	SERENA GILGIT
06	Gilgit → Skardu	*Soq Valley, speed boating, the Kachura lakes*	HIMMEL RESORT
07	Shigar Valley	*Shigar Fort, Sarfaranga, K2 Museum, Buddha Rock*	HIMMEL RESORT
08	Chunda Valley	*Jeep safari to the high pasture, optional polo*	HIMMEL RESORT
09	Islamabad	*Morning flight, spa day, farewell dinner*	NISHAT HOTEL
10	Islamabad	*Breakfast and airport transfer*	DEPARTURE

THE MAP

Three valleys, one loop

Hunza and Nagar on the Karakoram Highway, Baltistan down the Indus — with Islamabad a one-hour flight at either end.



Road journey · KKH & Jaglot–Skardu Road

Day excursions & jeep safaris

Flight · Islamabad ↔ Skardu (Days 2 & 9)

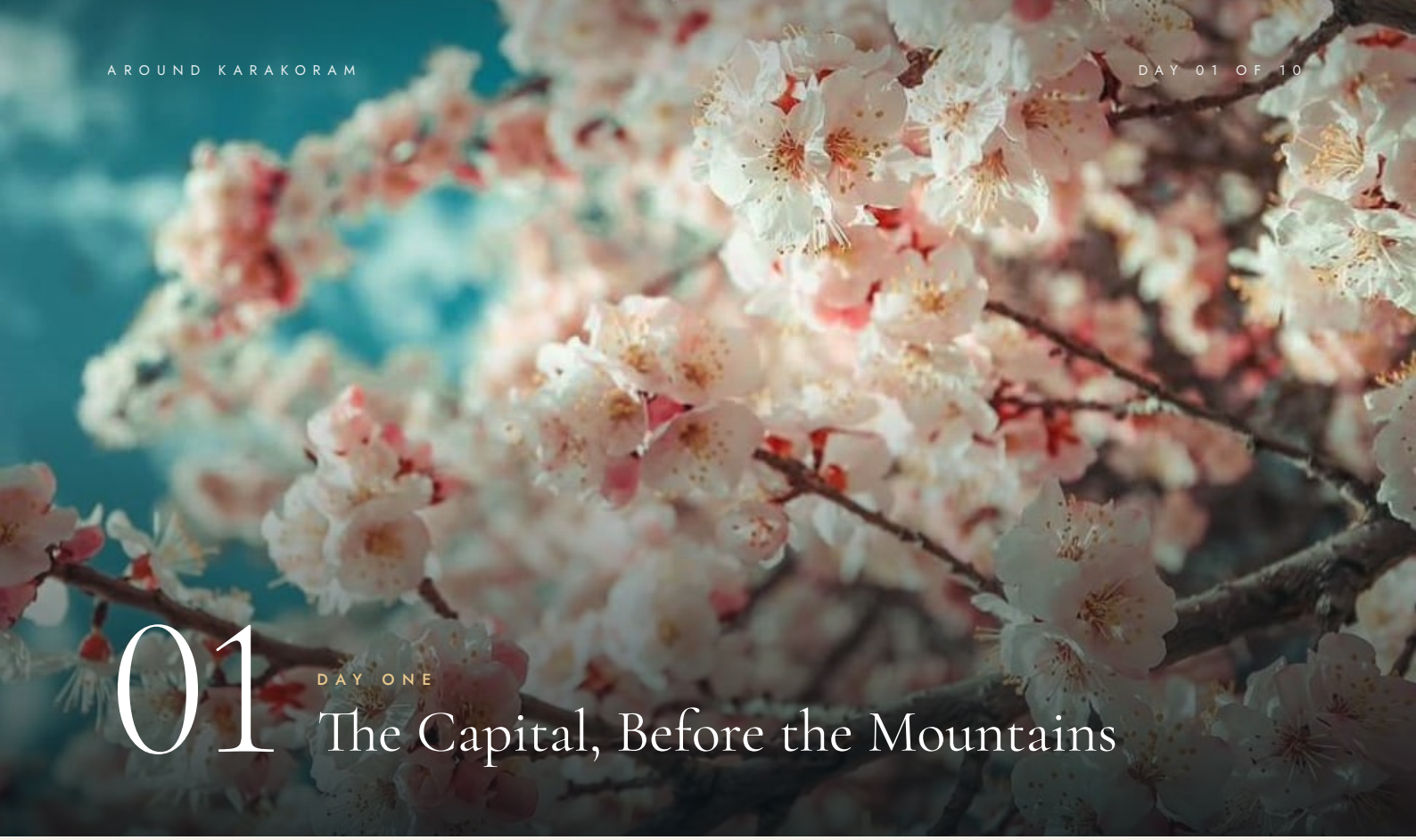
Overnight base

Stop & viewpoint

5 Day number

Relief drawn from elevation data. The dark line is the road you travel; dashed lines are the day trips and jeep safaris out from each base.

Nishat Hotel	Serena Hunza	Serena Gilgit	Himmel Resort
ISLAMABAD · NIGHTS 1 & 9	KARIMABAD · NIGHTS 2–4	GILGIT · NIGHT 5	SKARDU · NIGHTS 6–8



01 DAY ONE — The Capital, Before the Mountains

Faisal Mosque · Pakistan Monument · Saidpur Village · Monal

TRANSFERS	ALTITUDE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
Included	540 m	Dinner	Nishat Hotel, Islamabad

MORNING

Arrival at Islamabad International. Your guide meets the group in arrivals and the vehicle is already waiting. Transfer to the **Nishat Hotel**, check in, and time to shower off the flight before the city opens up.

AFTERNOON

Faisal Mosque first — Vedat Dalokay's Bedouin-tent design folded into the foot of the Margalla Hills, and one of the largest mosques in the world. Then the **Pakistan Monument** on Shakarparian ridge, four granite petals opening over the city, and **Saidpur Village**, a 500-year-old Mughal-era settlement swallowed whole by the modern capital.

EVENING

Up the Margalla Hills road to **Monal** for the arrival dinner, with Islamabad laid out below you in a grid of lights. Your guide runs the route briefing over dinner. Back to the Nishat for an early night — tomorrow is a dawn flight.

LOGISTICS

Private vehicle with driver from arrivals onward. Islamabad is a 45-minute run from the airport, and the Margalla road up to Monal is sealed the whole way.



Ali and his father

SECRET SPOT

On one small courtyard in Saidpur stand a Hindu temple, a Sikh gurdwara and a mosque, side by side and still standing. It is a two-minute walk off the restaurant terrace everyone else photographs, and nobody points it out.



DAY TWO

02 Over the Mountains, Then Along the Silk Road

Islamabad → Skardu by air · Jaglot–Skardu Road · Karakoram Highway · Hunza

FLIGHT	DRIVE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
~1 hr	6–6.5 hrs	B · L · D	Serena Hunza

MORNING

An early morning flight north. On a clear day this is one of the great aerial approaches anywhere — the Indus unspooling below, **Nanga Parbat** (8,126 m) close off the wing, and the Karakoram stacked along the horizon all the way in. At Skardu, your northern team is waiting with traditional caps and a proper local welcome — not a sign and a handshake, the real thing.

AFTERNOON

Then the drive that sets up the whole trip. The **Jaglot–Skardu Road** runs the Indus gorge before joining the **Karakoram Highway**, the paved descendant of the Silk Road itself. A relaxed lunch on the way, then two stops worth the clock: the **Nanga Parbat viewpoint**, and the restored **ruins of the old Silk Road**, conserved by AKRSP and the Aga Khan Foundation, where the caravan track is still legible in the rock.

EVENING

Last stop before the valley: the **Rakaposhi viewpoint** at Ghulmet, where the 27th-highest peak in the world rises almost six vertical kilometres out of the valley floor. Then the orchards start and you arrive at **Serena Hunza** in Karimabad. Hot shower, dinner at the hotel, and an early night.

LOGISTICS

Domestic flight Islamabad → Skardu included. Private vehicle with driver for the full transfer, broken into comfortable legs.



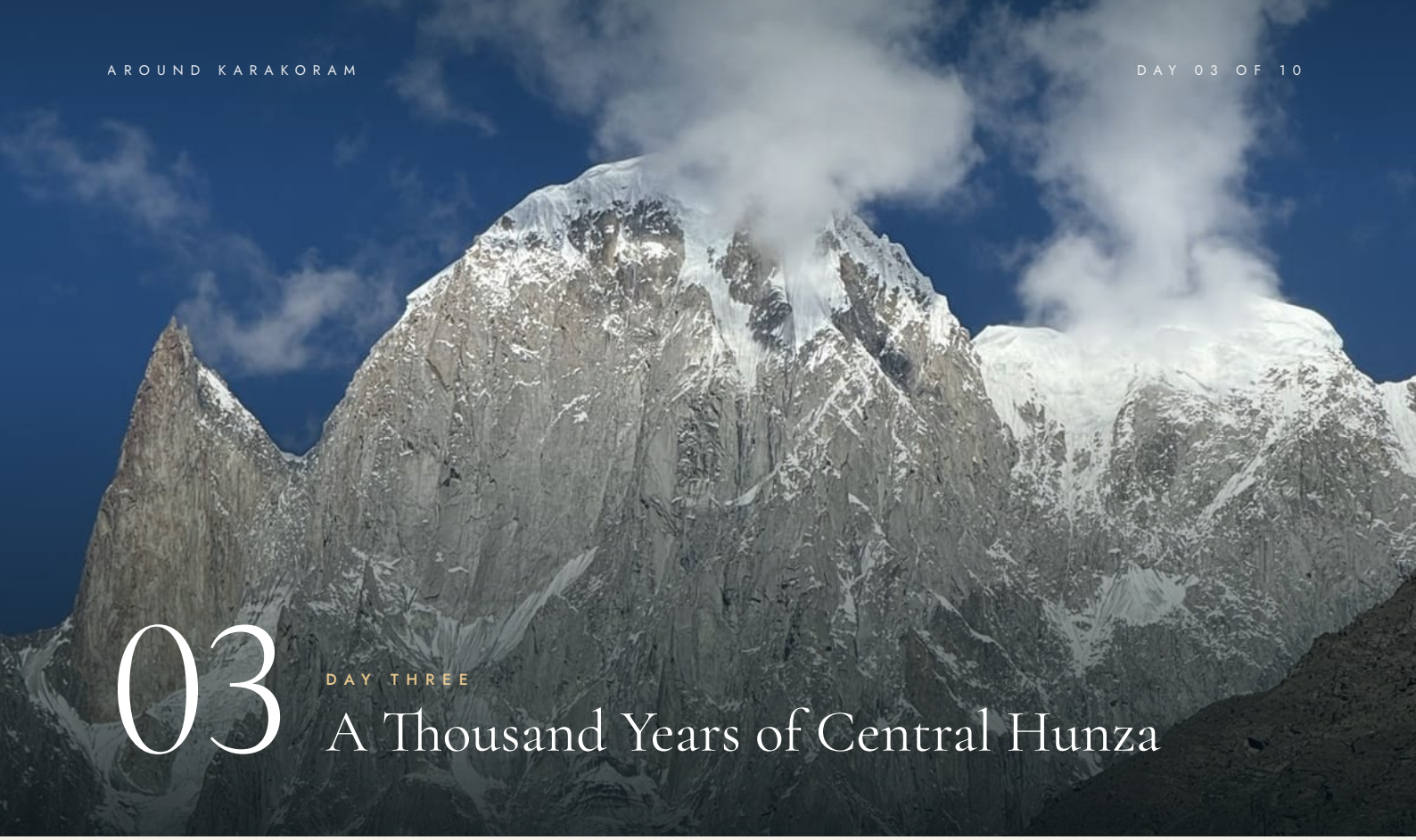
Touching down at Skardu

LOCAL INTERACTION

The cap you are handed at Skardu is not a souvenir — it is worn. Ask your guide how it is folded for your age and which valley the pattern belongs to. In Hunza it marks you as a guest of the house rather than a tourist, and people notice.

OUR ADVICE · ALTITUDE

You go from 540 m to 2,500 m in a single day. Nothing here is high enough to be dangerous, but drink more water than feels necessary for the first forty-eight hours.



03 DAY THREE — A Thousand Years of Central Hunza

Baltit Fort · Karimabad Bazaar · Altit Fort · Eagle's Nest

ON FOOT	DUIKAR	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
Easy · ~4 km	2,850 m	B · L · D	Serena Hunza

MORNING

Up through the old lanes to **Baltit Fort**, seat of the Mirs of Hunza for seven hundred years, restored by the Aga Khan Trust for Culture. Then the old **Karimabad Bazaar** — raw gemstones, apricot-kernel oil, hand-knitted caps — with a stop for walnut cake and apricot cake, which Hunza does better than anywhere.

AFTERNOON

Lunch is the centrepiece: a **400-year-old house** where a local family curates a full traditional Hunza table — chapshuro, diram phitti, hoi garma, apricot soup and mulberry tea, served in the original rooms. Then a slow stroll into **Altit Fort**, at roughly 1,100 years the oldest standing monument in Gilgit-Baltistan.

EVENING

Climb to **Duikar — the Eagle's Nest** for the panorama the valley is famous for: five peaks above seven thousand metres in one frame — Rakaposhi, Malubiting, Ultar Sar, Diran and Spantik — with Lady Finger spiking up in front. Back at Serena Hunza, a **traditional musical night**: rubab, damal drums and Burushaski folk song, played live over dinner.

LOGISTICS

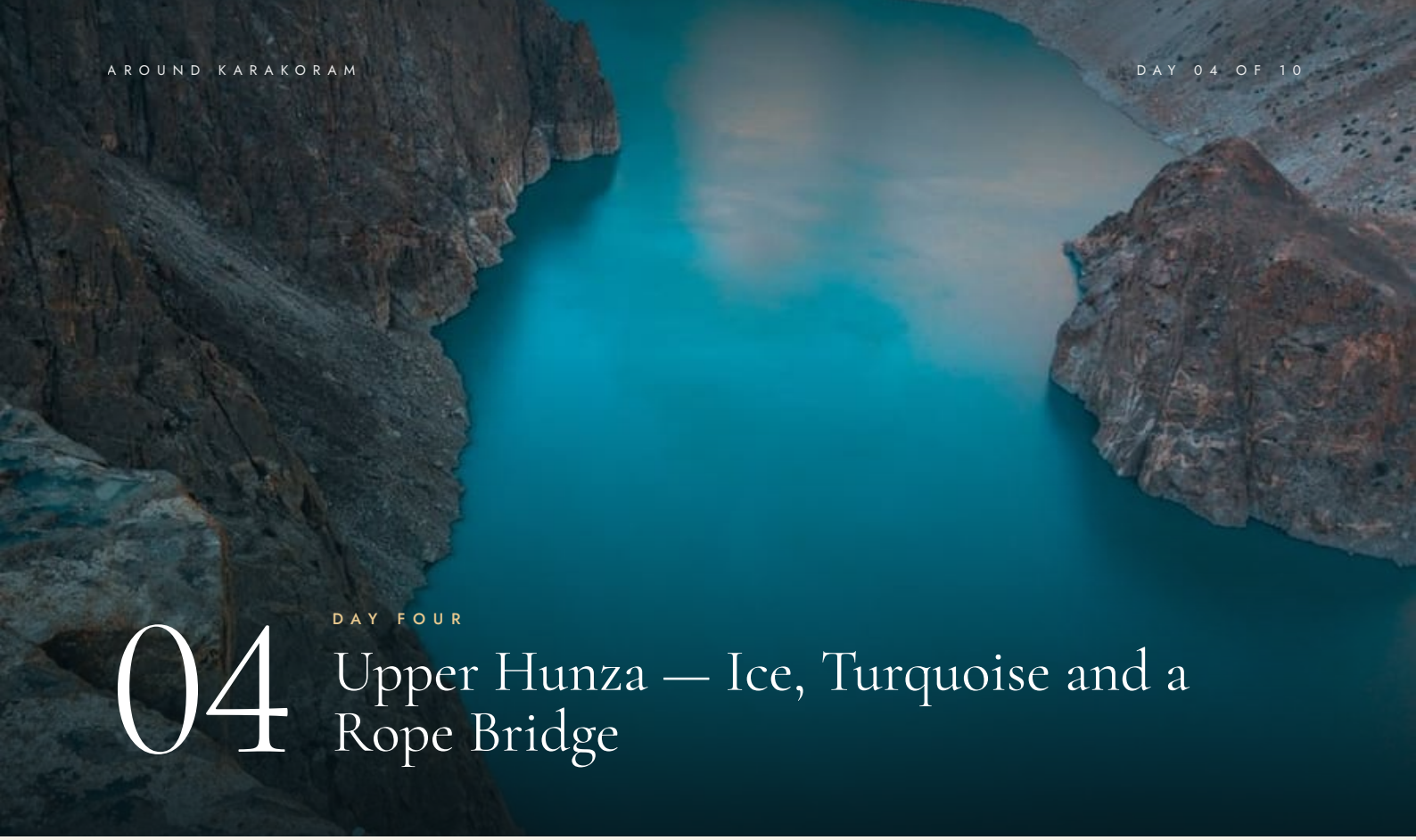
Mostly on foot through Karimabad and Altit, with the vehicle for short hops. The Duikar road is a series of tight switchbacks and is driven, not walked.



At Baltit Fort, Karimabad

SECRET SPOT

Twenty minutes below Karimabad lies Ganish Khun — a 1,000-year-old walled village of carved wooden mosques, watchtowers and a communal bathing pool, with a UNESCO conservation award to its name and a fraction of Baltit's visitors.



DAY FOUR

04 Upper Hunza — Ice, Turquoise and a Rope Bridge

Attabad Lake · Borith Lake · Passu Glacier · Hussaini Bridge · Passu Cones

HIKE	DRIVE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
30–40 min each way	~120 km return	B · L · D	Serena Hunza

MORNING

North into Gojal, the Wakhi-speaking upper valley. **Attabad Lake** comes first — twenty-one kilometres of impossible turquoise created by the landslide of January 2010. Through the five Pak–China Friendship Tunnels that replaced the drowned road, then up to **Borith Lake** (2,600 m), on the migratory flyway.

AFTERNOON

From Borith, a 30–40 minute hike to the snout of the **Passu Glacier** — white ice, grinding and cracking, close enough to feel the cold coming off it. Down then to the **Hussaini Suspension Bridge**: cable, missing planks, and the Hunza River moving fast underneath. Crossing is optional and so is the zip line; watching from the bank is a perfectly respectable choice.

EVENING

On to the **Passu Cones** — the Tupopdan ridge at 6,106 m, the most photographed skyline in Pakistan. A late lunch at the **Yak Grill**, then stay for the hour the light runs along the cones, the shot the whole day is built around. Back to Serena Hunza for the last dinner in the valley.

LOGISTICS

Private vehicle all day on sealed KKH tarmac. The glacier walk is entirely optional; the vehicle waits at Borith either way.



Lunch beside Borith Lake

LOCAL INTERACTION

In Gulmit, the Bulbulik Heritage Music School teaches Wakhi children the old valley songs on rubab and ghazhek. Drop in between classes and they will usually play one. No ticket, no schedule — your guide calls ahead.

OUR ADVICE · GEAR

The Passu Glacier walk and the Hussaini Bridge both want proper shoes with grip. Everything else is doable in trainers — this is not the day to find out your soles are smooth.



05 DAY FIVE Rakaposhi from the Cricket Ground

Karimabad → Minapin · Maichar Koh / Pissan · Nagar → Gilgit

JEEP SAFARI	DRIVE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
Included	~3 hrs total	B · L · D	Serena Gilgit

MORNING

Early start south into Nagar Valley and the old village of **Minapin**, where the vehicle hands over to jeeps. The climb to **Maichar Koh — the Pissan natural cricket ground** — ends at a full-size pitch cut into a high shelf of the mountain, with **Rakaposhi** (7,788 m) standing directly behind the boundary and the ridge running east to Diran. There is no hurry here.

AFTERNOON

Back down to Minapin for the second of the trip's great meals: a **traditional Nagar lunch** prepared by the village, cooked with local spices and entirely organic, the meat slow-cooked in a **400-year-old stone pot** to recipes that have not changed in generations. Aromatic, unhurried and not on any menu.

EVENING

Rejoin the Karakoram Highway south for **Gilgit**, the old crossroads of the Karakoram, the Himalaya and the Hindu Kush. Check in at **Serena Gilgit**, dinner, and a quiet night.



The stone-pot lunch in Nagar

LOCAL INTERACTION

If there is a match on at Pissan, the village will wave you in. Nagar takes its cricket seriously, and visitors tend to be handed tea and a place on the boundary wall within four minutes of arriving.

LOGISTICS

Private vehicle Karimabad → Minapin → Gilgit, with 4x4 jeeps for the Minapin ↔ Maichar Koh leg, which no road vehicle climbs. Jeep safari included.



06 DAY SIX Down the Indus to Baltistan

Gilgit → Skardu · Soq Valley · Upper & Lower Kachura

DRIVE	ALTITUDE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
~3.5 hrs	2,230 m	B · L · D	Himmel Resort, Skardu

MORNING

Breakfast at Serena Gilgit, then east onto the **Jaglot–Skardu Road** — three and a half hours of Indus gorge, with sheer rock on one side, grey glacial water on the other, and almost nothing in between. One of the great drives in Asia, and it earns every minute.

AFTERNOON

Into Baltistan and straight to **Soq Valley**, where white-water streams come down off the mountain in braided channels through a green shelf of pasture. Tea and snacks are set up beside the water. Then **Upper Kachura Lake** for speed boating on cold, clear snowmelt — included in your package — with an optional zip line across the water. Lunch at **Lower Kachura — Shangri-La**, where the old gardens run right down to the lake.

EVENING

Short transfer out to **Himmel Resort**, your base for the next three nights. Check in, and the pace of the trip drops a gear. Dinner at the resort and an unhurried evening.



Lower Kachura — Shangri-La

SECRET SPOT

From Upper Kachura a footpath drops toward the Indus channel in about ten minutes. Almost everyone shoots the lake from the near shore and turns back; the frame from down there — water in front, Karakoram behind — is the better one.

LOGISTICS

Private Toyota Grand Cabin with driver the full day. Speed boating at Upper Kachura is included; the zip line is run by a local operator and paid on site if anyone wants it.



DAY SEVEN

07 Shigar Valley — Fort, Desert, Museum, Buddha

Shigar Fort · Sarfaranga Cold Desert · K2 Museum · Manthal Buddha Rock

DRIVE	PACE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
~45 min each way	Light	B · L · D	Himmel Resort, Skardu

MORNING

A full day in the Shigar Valley, starting with **Shigar Fort** — Fong Khar, the Palace on the Rock. The 17th-century seat of the Raja of Shigar, restored over seven years by the Aga Khan Trust for Culture: carved wooden chambers, courtyard gardens, and shade and seating the whole way round.

AFTERNOON

Out onto the **Sarfaranga Cold Desert**, one of the highest cold deserts on earth — white dunes running straight into the Karakoram wall, reached entirely by vehicle. Lunch, then back into Skardu for the **K2 Museum**: the expeditions, the Balti porters who carried them, and the gear that came back off the Savage Mountain.

EVENING

The **Manthal Buddha Rock**, a nine-metre standing Buddha carved into a granite boulder in the 8th century, when this valley was Buddhist. Then a little leisure in the **Skardu bazaar** — dried apricots, gemstones and Balti woollens — before dinner at Himmel Resort.

LOGISTICS

Private Grand Cabin. If the group would rather catch Sarfaranga at sunset, say so in the morning and we flip the order — the dunes turn copper in the last hour of light.



Family and friends at Satpara Lake, Skardu

SECRET SPOT

Ten minutes from Shigar Fort stands the Amburiq Mosque, built in the 14th century by Kashmiri craftsmen — the oldest mosque in Baltistan, with a UNESCO Asia-Pacific award. No car park, no ticket desk, usually nobody there.



08 DAY EIGHT Up to Chunda

Jeep safari to Chunda Valley · Skardu · optional polo

JEEP SAFARI	PACE	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
Included	Easy	B · L · D	Himmel Resort, Skardu

MORNING

The jeeps come for you after breakfast. **Chunda Valley** sits high above the Skardu basin, a broad shelf of pasture and orchard reached by a track no road vehicle attempts. The valley opens onto a view of the Indus, the Shigar confluence and the whole basin at once — and in spring, the **apricot and cherry blossom** comes through in waves of white and pink against bare rock and snow.

AFTERNOON

Time up there is left deliberately loose — walk the orchard terraces, sit with the view, let the content creator work. Back down to Skardu for a late lunch. If there is a **polo match** on at the Skardu ground, we go: Gilgit-Baltistan plays the old free-style game with almost no rules, a live band on the sidelines, and a crowd that takes it extremely seriously.

EVENING

The rest of the day is yours at **Himmel Resort** — the last afternoon in the mountains, and the right one to do nothing with. Dinner at the resort.

LOGISTICS

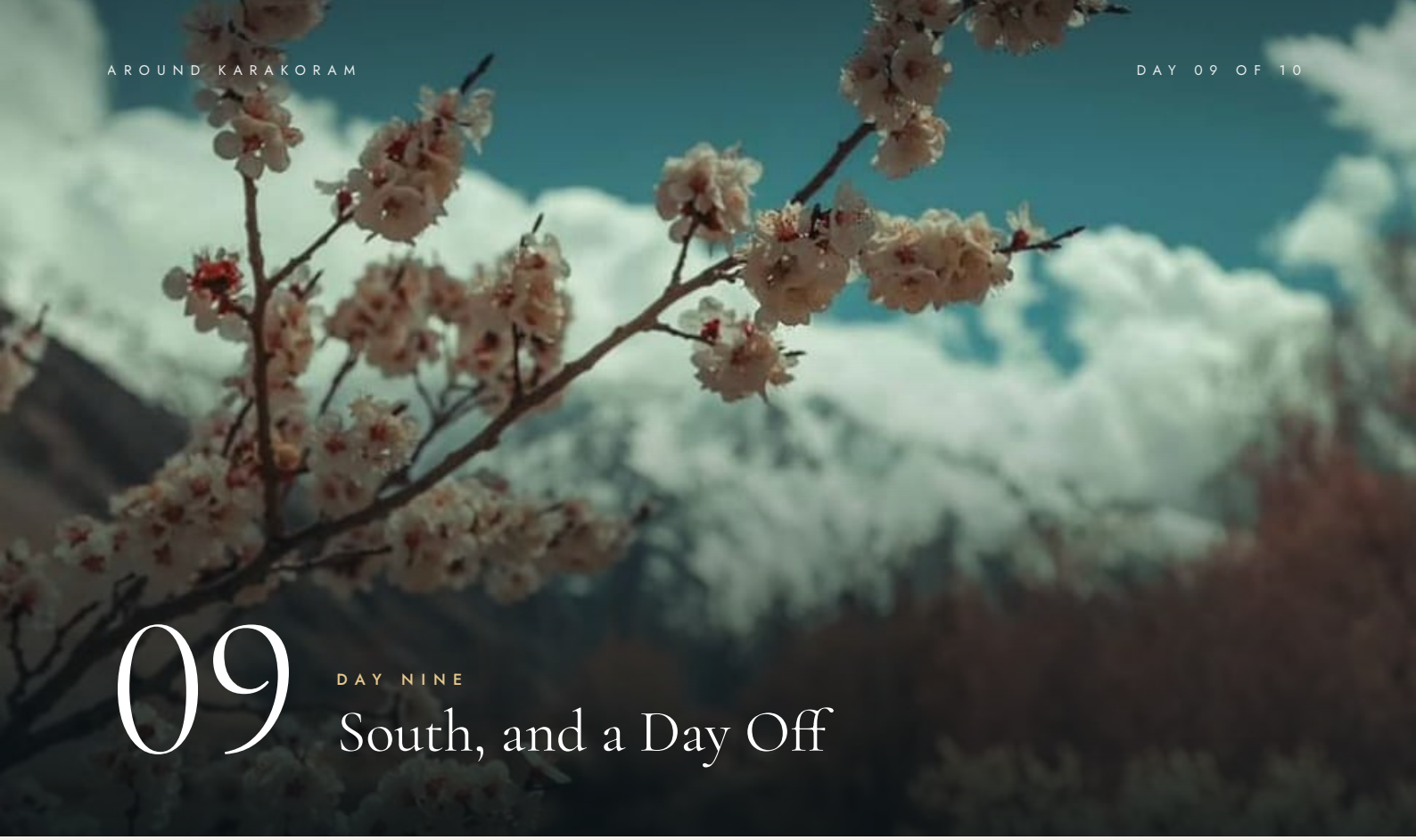
4x4 jeep safari included for the climb to Chunda and back. The road is rough, the jeeps are not, and the whole thing is done seated.

LOCAL INTERACTION

Free-style polo is the real thing here, not a demonstration for visitors. There is no fixture list we can promise in advance, so your guide checks the week you arrive. If a match is on, it is the most alive hour you will spend in Baltistan.

OUR ADVICE · SEASONALITY

Chunda is at its most spectacular from late March to early May, when the blossom comes through the orchards. It is worth seeing in every other season too — and if you are travelling between June and September, the Deosai Plains at 4,114 m can be swapped in for this day on request.



09 DAY NINE — South, and a Day Off

Skardu → Islamabad by air · Leisure & spa · Farewell dinner

FLIGHT	AFTERNOON	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
~1 hr	At leisure	B · L · D	Nishat Hotel, Islamabad

MORNING

Early breakfast at the resort, then the short transfer to Skardu airport for the **one-hour flight back to Islamabad** — the same mountains you have spent a week inside, laid out beneath you on the way out. Our Islamabad team meets the group at arrivals.

AFTERNOON

Straight to the **Nishat Hotel**, freshen up, and then the day is deliberately empty: **leisure, and the spa** if you want it. A long lunch, the pool, or nothing at all. After eight days of mountain roads, this is the day everybody ends up grateful for.

EVENING

A **farewell dinner** at one of Islamabad's best tables, chosen to suit the group, with your guide and the content creator handing over the **first cut of the film** and stills from the journey.

LOGISTICS

Domestic flight Skardu → Islamabad included, with meet-and-greet at arrivals and private transfers at both ends. Spa treatments are booked on the day and settled directly.



Ali and his father

LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

If anyone still wants to shop, Jinnah Super and Kohsar Market are twenty minutes away and open late — carpets, pashmina, gemstones and dried fruit at capital prices rather than airport ones.

10 DAY TEN Homeward

Nishat Hotel → Islamabad International (ISB)

TRANSFER	ENDS	MEALS	OVERNIGHT
~45 min	At the airport	Breakfast	Tour concludes

MORNING

Breakfast at the hotel and check out at a time that suits your flight. Private transfer to **Islamabad International**, with your guide staying until the group is through check-in.

AFTERNOON

The complete **photo and video package** travels home with you — ten days, three valleys, four forts, five peaks over seven thousand metres, and a set of memories to cherish.

LOGISTICS

Private Grand Cabin with driver for the airport transfer. Guide in attendance through check-in.



At Satpara Lake, above Skardu

LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

If your flight is late in the day, tell us in advance — we hold day-use rooms and add a short Margalla Hills loop rather than leave anybody sitting on a suitcase in a lobby.

IN THE FIELD

Small groups, real people

Every Facing North departure travels with the same core: a guide who grew up in these valleys, a driver who knows every bend of the Indus, a host who grew up in these valleys, and a content creator who makes sure you spend the trip looking at the mountains rather than your phone.



Under the Passu Cones, Upper Hunza



The content creator at work, Karimabad

THE FINE PRINT, UPFRONT

Inclusions & Exclusions

WHAT IS INCLUDED

- **Nine nights' accommodation**
  Nishat Hotel Islamabad (2), Serena Hunza (3), Serena Gilgit (1), Himmel Resort Skardu (3)
- **Domestic flights**
  Islamabad → Skardu and Skardu → Islamabad
- **All meals, arrival to departure**
  9 breakfasts, 8 lunches and 9 dinners — Day 1 is the arrival dinner only; Day 10 is breakfast only
- **All transportation**
  Private Toyota Grand Cabin with driver for ten days — fuel, tolls, parking and airport transfers
- **English-speaking guide**
  With the group for the entire journey
- **Dedicated content creator**
  Professional video and photography, delivered as a finished package
- **Traditional musical night in Hunza**
  Live folk music by local musicians at the Nishat Hotel
- **Two heritage kitchens**
  The 400-year-old house in Karimabad and the stone-pot lunch in Nagar
- **Jeep safaris**
  Chunda Valley and Maichar Koh / Pissan cricket ground
- **All entry tickets and site permits**
  Baltit, Altit, Shigar Fort, the K2 Museum, Manthal Buddha Rock and every other site on the itinerary
- **Speed boating**
  At Upper Kachura Lake on Day 6
- **Visa documentation support**
  Invitation letter and supporting paperwork
- **Traditional welcome**
  Caps and a proper greeting from our northern team at Skardu

WHAT IS NOT

- International flights to and from Islamabad
- Pakistan visa fees — we prepare the documentation, you pay the fee
- Travel and medical insurance — strongly recommended
- Optional activities — zip lines at Upper Kachura and Hussaini Bridge, polo match entry
- Spa and wellness treatments on Day 9
- Lunch on Day 1, and lunch and dinner on Day 10
- Beverages outside the included meals
- Laundry, telephone, paid Wi-Fi and personal items
- Personal shopping and souvenirs
- Tips for guide, driver and crew, at your discretion
- Medical costs, evacuation and rescue
- Costs from landslides, road closures, weather or flight delays
- Anything not explicitly listed as included

BOOK THIS JOURNEY

Scan with your phone camera

or tap to open the booking form.

BOOK NOW





YOUR CO-HOST · TRAVEL SPECIALIST

Travelling with Ali Imran

This departure is co-hosted by **Ali Imran** for Facing North Travels. Ali travels with the group from the moment you land to the moment you check in for your flight home — and unlike most hosts on trips to Northern Pakistan, he is not visiting. *He grew up here.*

A DOCTOR'S SON IN THE NORTH	Ali is the son of a well-known doctor whose medical postings took the family across the northern areas of Pakistan, and he spent part of his early schooling in Skardu itself. The valleys on this itinerary are not research for him — they are the places he grew up moving between, year after year, as his father was posted from one station to the next.
WHAT THAT ACTUALLY GIVES YOU	Decades of first-hand time in Baltistan, Hunza, Nagar and Gilgit: the heritage, the languages, the food, the etiquette, and the hundred small things a visiting host simply cannot know. He knows which fort custodian will open a room that is normally closed, which kitchen cooks the better chapshuro, and which viewpoint is worth the extra twenty minutes.
THE INTERNATIONAL SIDE	Ali also brings a long background in international tourism — he studied in Southeast Asia and has spent extensive time in the United Kingdom and the United States. He understands exactly what an international traveller expects from a trip, and where Pakistan needs explaining rather than defending.
LOCAL DEPTH, INTERNATIONAL STANDARD	That combination is rare, and it is the whole reason this departure exists. You get the access and the stories of somebody genuinely from these mountains, delivered to the standard of someone who has travelled, studied and worked across three continents.
ON THE GROUND	Ali hosts this journey with the Facing North ground team, and a dedicated content creator travels with the group throughout. Between them, nobody in your party has to stop and take the photograph themselves.



YOUR HOST'S STORY

Ali's road north

Ali Imran is your host on this journey — and the north is not new ground for him. His father is a well-known doctor whose medical postings moved the family across Pakistan, and those moves carried Ali deep into the northern valleys as a boy. He spent some of his early years in **Skardu** itself — one of the main bases of this trip — growing up between the places this route is built on.

Since then, Ali has travelled across the world — studying in Southeast Asia and spending extensive time in the United Kingdom and the United States. A childhood in these mountains and a life of travel well beyond them: that is what makes him the *travel specialist* you will be experiencing Northern Pakistan with.



Ali with family and friends at Satpara Lake, Skardu



Ali and his father

WHEN TO TRAVEL

This journey runs all year

Every element of this itinerary operates in every season. Only Day 8 changes with the calendar — Deosai in summer, Chunda Valley the rest of the year — and the valleys themselves look completely different depending on when you come.



Spring

MARCH – MAY

Blossom season, and the best window for Chunda Valley. The Hunza, Nagar and Skardu orchards turn pink and white with apricot and cherry blossom, usually from late March through April. Cool, clear and quiet.



Summer

JUNE – AUGUST

Everything open and every high road clear. Warmest weather, longest days, polo season in full swing, and the window in which the Deosai Plains can be swapped into Day 8 on request.



Autumn

SEPTEMBER – OCTOBER

The photographers' season. The orchards turn gold, the air is at its clearest of the year, and the peaks come out sharp against the sky. The best light of the twelve months.



Winter

NOVEMBER – FEBRUARY

Quiet, cold and startlingly beautiful: snow on the forts, frozen lake edges, and almost nobody else in the valleys. Everything on this itinerary still runs, and hotel availability is at its easiest.

FACING NORTH RECOMMENDS CHOOSING YOUR WINDOW

If you are coming for the mountains, come in late September or October: the clearest air of the year, gold in the orchards, and the peaks at their sharpest. If you are coming for Deosai, you need July or August. If you want the valleys almost to yourselves, come in winter — and bring a warmer coat than you think.


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